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The innermost layer lining the lumen of the alimentary canal is the mucosa which secretes mucous.

Though the bile juice of liver has no digestive enzyme but is very essential for proper digestion of food, especially of the fats. Discuss the following?

a) What is composition of bile?
b) How it helps in digestion of fats and other nutrients of food?
c) How it helps in absorption of fats?

5.1.3 Digestive glands

Digestive glands are exocrine glands which secrete biological catalysts called enzymes. The digestive glands associated with the alimentary canal are salivary glands, liver and pancreas. Stomach wall has gastric glands that secrete gastric juice and the intestinal mucosa secretes intestinal juice.

Salivary glands

There are three pairs of salivary glands in the mouth. They are the largest parotids gland in the cheeks, the sub-maxillary/ sub-mandibular in the lower jaw and the sublingual beneath the tongue. These glands have ducts such as **Stenson's duct, Wharton's duct and Bartholin's duct or duct of Rivinis** respectively (Figure. 5.6)**.** The salivary juice secreated by the salivary glands reaches the mouth through these ducts. The daily secretion of saliva from salivary glands ranges from 1000 to 1500mL.

Gastric glands

The wall of the stomach is lined by gastric glands. Chief cells or **peptic cells or zymogen cells** in the gastric glands secrete gastric enzymes and **Goblet cells** secrete mucus. The **Parietal or oxyntic cells** secrete HCl and an intrinsic factor responsible for the absorption of Vitamin B_{12} called Castle's intrinsic factor.

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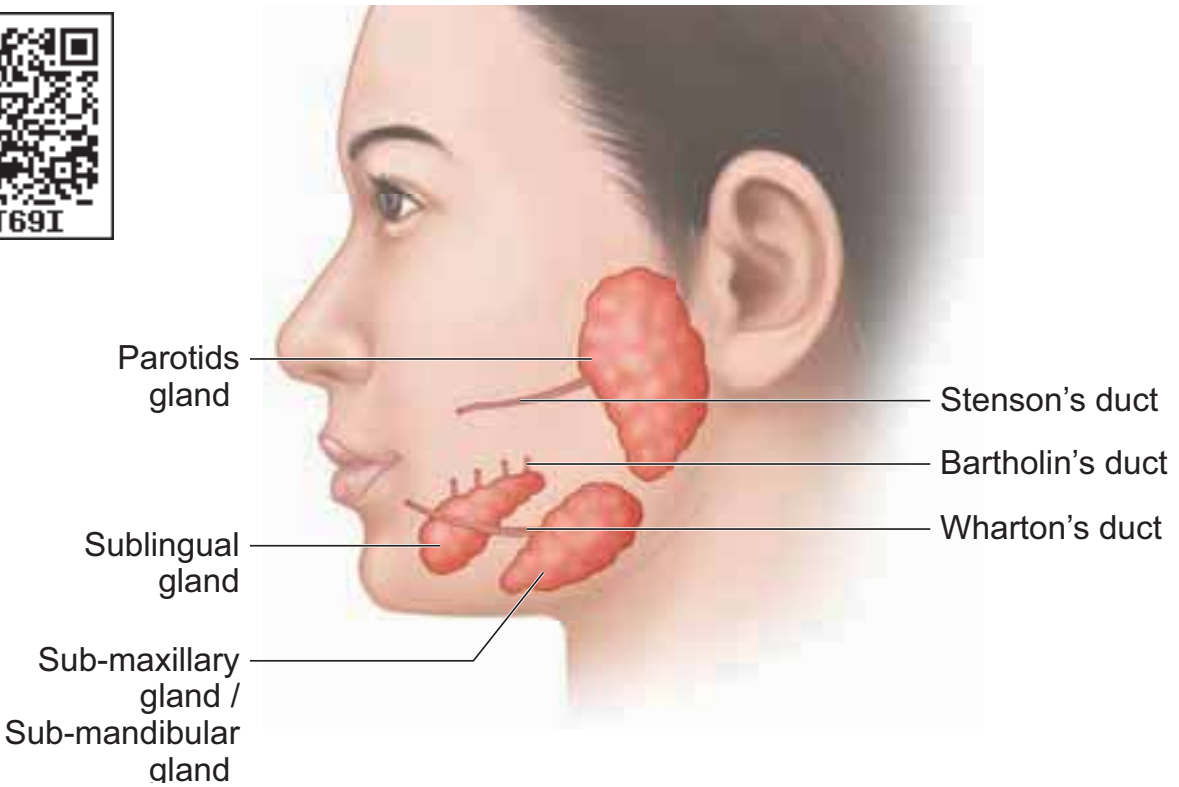

Figure 5.6 Salivary glands